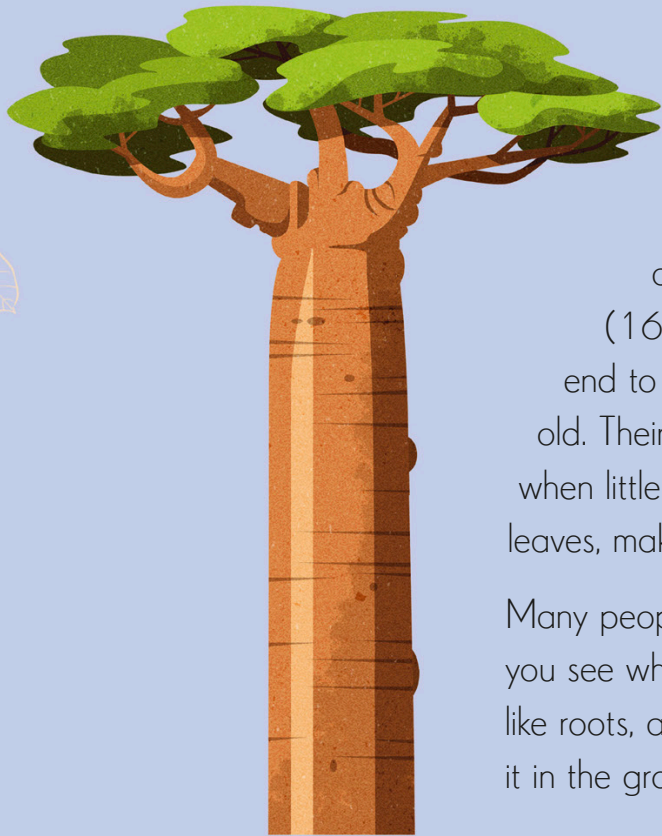




With their enormous trunks, baobabs (bay-oh-babs) are the fattest trees of them all. If you hold a tape measure around their middle, some are almost 50 m (164 ft) round – the same as two tennis courts end to end. Often these trees are hundreds of years old. Their mighty trunks store water for the dry season, when little rain falls. When it is dry the trees lose their leaves, making them look almost dead.

Many people call the baobab the “upside-down tree”. Can you see why? Its branches at the top are short and tangled like roots, as if a giant has picked the tree up and planted it in the ground the wrong way up.

Grandidier's baobab,
Madagascar

